

Pietro Pellerito

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Fields of Interest

Labor, Public, Economics of Education

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Notre Dame	May 2027 (exp.)
M.A. Economics, University of Notre Dame	July 2022
B.S. Applied Mathematics, Kettering University (Minor - Economics)	June 2021

Job Market Paper

“Breaking Boundaries: Competitive Effects of Inter-District School Choice”

Abstract: Inter-district school choice (IDSC) allows students to attend public schools outside their residential districts and may improve educational quality by exposing districts to enrollment pressure. I test this claim empirically by exploiting an unanticipated Indiana funding reform that eliminated transfer tuition in 2010, sharply reducing household participation costs. Using statewide student-level administrative data, I estimate a continuous difference-in-differences model where school districts’ enrollment-threat exposure is constructed from pre-policy achievement gaps with neighboring districts. A one-standard-deviation increase in exposure produces a net enrollment loss through transfer students equal to 2.06 percent of district enrollment, while reducing the initial value-added gap between lower- and higher-exposure districts by 5.3 percent. Quality gains are concentrated in elementary grades. Consistent with stronger incentives from enrollment losses, competitive effects are larger in smaller, geographically compact districts, where losses are harder to absorb and alternatives are more accessible. These findings identify enrollment incentives as a channel through which reducing barriers to IDSC can reduce educational inequality.

Working Papers

“Staying Connected: Experimental Effects of Weekly Text Messages in an Adult High School”
with Patrick Turner and Alberto Ortega

Selected Works in Progress

“Firm Behavior to Dual Minimum Wage Policies” – with Tim Spilde
“Do ILEARN More? Retention, Resources, and Future Academic Attainment”

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Patrick Turner, University of Notre Dame	2024–2026
Research Assistant to Niharika Singh, University of Notre Dame	2023–2024
Research Assistant to Petros Ioannatos, Kettering University	2020

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics	2024
Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, LP Statistics for Economics	2023
Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics	2022
Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Microeconomics I	2019
Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Calculus II	2018

Fellowships, Awards, and Affiliations

Notre Dame Program for Interdisciplinary Education Research (PIER)	2023–2027
Awarded annual \$2,500 research stipend	
Graduate Student Research Award	2024
Totaled \$4,000	
Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities Research Affiliate	2026–Present

Presentations

2026 - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; Association for Education Finance and Policy; Leuven Economics of Education Research; Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics; MidSouth Education Policy (Scheduled); Midwest Economics of Education (Scheduled); Southern Economic Association (Scheduled); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Scheduled)

2025 - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; MidSouth Education Policy; Midwest Sociology of Education Conference

Work Experience

Actuarial Intern, Willis Towers Watson	2018–2020
Purchasing Assistant, LEER Corporation	2017–2018

Attributes and Skills

Computational Skills: Stata, L^AT_EX, Excel (Advanced) Matlab, Python, SPSS (proficient)

Applied Methods: RCT design, causal inference methods, value-added estimation, event studies

Federal Access, Credentials, & Compliance: U.S Census Bureau Special Sworn Status, Restricted-Use Federal Data Authorization

References

Jim Sullivan (Chair)	Jeffrey Denning	Patrick Turner
Professor of Economics	Associate Professor of Public Policy	Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Notre Dame	University of Texas	University of Notre Dame
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**Updated 2026-09-26*